

The Finance Committee
Town of Westhampton
Town Hall
1 South Road
Westhampton, Massachusetts 01027

Minutes of the Meeting
Wednesday April 29, 2026

Call to Order

The meeting was called to order at 7:05 P.M.

Present for Finance Committee: Tad Weiss (Chair), Jennifer Milikowsky (Fincom and SB), Jon Albitz, Maureen Dempsey, Steve Holt, Scott Stanton, Jeremy Durrin (note-taker)

Also attending Select Board members: Scott Johndrow, Susan Bronstein (Chair)

Also attending: Morley Cleary, Peter Cleary, Vito Perrone, Thomas Cleary Jr., Dawn Scaparotti, Julia Lennen, Andrea McGrath, Glenda Cresto, Jeff Brooks, Shelby Marowitz, Kelly O'Connel, Jennifer Thomas, Marylou Burgess.

Review of Minutes

Motion to approve 4/27/2026 minutes made by Holt, seconded by Stanton.

VOTE TO APPROVE: 7-0-0

Discussion

Weiss gave an overview of the current budget deficit to highlight the position we are in for the WES school committee and public to understand the cuts still needed to take place. The committee still needed to identify an additional \$35,000 in cuts to the municipal and education budgets to balance the budget along with free cash and a potential override. This would be on top of the expected cut of roughly \$45,000 from the elementary school budget which was not voted on by the WES School Committee at the start of our meeting.

WES school committee expressed their ability to use a Revolving Fund to pay down approximately \$45,000 from their budget, and thus lowering the town's responsibility by the same amount.

4th highway position, which is currently a vacant position, was discussed and the finance committee proposed tying the \$65,000 salary to a potential override to allow the towns people decide on this position.

Highway Materials- We recommended cutting the highway materials budget by \$10,000.

Highway Clerk position was recommended to be cut from the budget for a total savings of \$10,592. It was pointed out that the year the town created this role was when we had thought the town had a surplus going into town meeting. It was later discovered that we in fact had a deficit and if we had known that prior to funding the position it would most likely not have been funded.

Override amount to balance budget

Motion to recommend to the Select Board, \$125,000 as the total override amount to balance the budget was made by Durrin. Seconded by Dempsey.

VOTE TO APPROVE: 7-0-0

Use of Free Cash to balance the budget

Motion to use \$125,000 in free cash to balance the budget was made by Durrin. Seconded by Holt.

VOTE TO APPROVE: 7-0-0

WES School Committee. - The committee voted to reduce the town's total burden by \$57,000. The \$57K was composed of the above mentioned \$45k plus another \$12K additional "ask" of the school to balance the overall budget. Westhampton's share of their total budget stands at \$2,136,873.

Budget Voting

100 Series (General Government)

Weiss motioned to accept all category 100 series items as recommended by the finance committee for a total of \$418,556. Durrin Seconded.

VOTE TO APPROVE: 7-0-0

200 Series (Public Safety)

Weiss motioned to accept all category 200 series items as recommended by the finance committee for a total of \$329,060. Durrin Seconded.

VOTE TO APPROVE: 6-0-1

300 Series (Education)

Weiss motioned to accept all category 300 series items as recommended by the finance committee for a total of \$4,337,599. Durrin Seconded.

VOTE TO APPROVE: 6-0-1

400 Series (Public Works)

Weiss motioned to accept all category 400 series items as recommended by the finance committee for a total of \$750,057 Durrin Seconded.

VOTE TO APPROVE: 6-0-1

500 Series (Human Services)

Weiss motioned to accept all category 500 series items as recommended by the finance committee for a total of \$70,336. Durrin Seconded.

VOTE TO APPROVE: 7-0-0

600 Series (Culture & Rec.)

Weiss motioned to accept all category 600 series items as recommended by the finance committee for a total of \$137,740. Durrin Seconded.

VOTE TO APPROVE: 6-0-1

700 Series (Debt Services)

Weiss motioned to accept all category 700 series items as recommended by the finance committee for a total of \$298,590. Durrin Seconded.

VOTE TO APPROVE: 7-0-0

800 Series (Intergovernmental Services)

Weiss motioned to accept all category 800 series items as recommended by the finance committee for a total of \$325.00. Durrin Seconded.

VOTE TO APPROVE: 7-0-0

900 Series (Debt Services)

Weiss motioned to accept all category 900 series items as recommended by the finance committee for a total of \$1,341,796. Durrin Seconded.

VOTE TO APPROVE: 7-0-0

Discussion that the remainder of voting on the budget (Warrant Articles) will be done at the next FinCom meeting, just prior to the Monday SB meeting, May 4th at 6:00.
Posting of this meeting would be forthcoming.

Motion to adjourn by Durrin seconded by Holt at 9:10 P.M.

VOTE TO APPROVE: 7-0-0